Sustainability Table SERIES

BACKING THE FUTURE

Ahmed Abiodun || Anthea Epelle
Gods of Indigo || Musa Ganiyy
Nwajiaku Uche || Nwocha Ernest
Nzekwe Phillip || Olushola Olajobi
Prince Obasi || Samuel Olowomeye
Uchay Joel Chima

A SUSTAINABILITY AND ART EXHIBITION



Curated by - Naomi Edobor

Preface

As efforts are being made globally towards achieving the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), we must begin to find innovative ways to communicate issues of sustainability, especially as it pertains to the environment.

While there are several campaigns about climate change, global warming and rising sea levels, we must ensure that we are telling the stories in relatable and creative forms.

Backing The Future is an Art Exhibition that is targeted to serve as a visual and artistic expression of the 2022 Sustainability Discourse Series (STS)

The Sustainability Table Discourse Series (STS) is a platform that brings together policy makers, entrepreneurs, sustainable development experts, leading corporate organisations and various subject matter experts to share ideas/initiatives and proffer solutions to challenges facing selected industries as it relates to the environment, climate change, sustainability. The platform, which is now in its fifth-year, focuses on achieving the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), a digital, circular and green economy, likewise working on multilateral, regional or continental African and global issues.

Among the objectives of this year s edition is to stir conversations and have genuine arguments in the direction of sustainability to achieve the SDGs.

The art exhibition explores the relationship between earth and her inhabitants as well as the many ways the earth communicates with us. We have identified that art is as much a powerful storytelling tool as it provides a creative channel to effective waste management. Hence, the exhibition brings together prolific artists who are passionate about sustainability and employ waste materials to create beautiful works of art.

We hope that each artwork, just like the earth, would speak to the mind of the viewers, inspiring a sense of sustainability and spurring ideas and initiatives that proffer solutions to issues of sustainable development in our nation towards a sustainable future.

Kayode Olaniyan
Convener, Sustainability Table Discourse



Backing The Future

Are we shaping the future we want?

Sustainability was a topic decades ago; it's now such a glaring reality. We constantly hear the questions: Where do we start, What do we do, How do we engage the community, What role does digital play?

Backing the Future as a group exhibition intends to answer these questions and raise awareness about behaviours that ripple into detrimental changes within our environment. The show features nature-inspired artists and environmental activists who are radically enabling better practices by; Reducing, Reusing and Recycling materials for art and also painting a picture of the ecosystem we need to preserve.

The starting point of this year's exhibition concerns SDG 13: Climate Action, which specifically targets 13.3, which is to Improve education, awareness-raising and human and institutional capacity on climate change mitigation, adaptation, impact reduction and early warning. The exhibition considers these critical themes by presenting works that use materiality as the basis for communication and aesthetic experience, providing context, physicality, impact, and, subsequently, meaning.

Indeed, the enhanced visibility of the relationship between man and his environment is key to examining a more significant theme, offering moments of reflection on whether it all matters. An article by the National Environmental Education Foundation (NEEF) published, ''Species are migrating ten times faster, and feeding and breeding patterns continue to change due to man's actions in his environment''.

In response, this year's Avant Garde Sustainability Series focuses on Sustainable Development Goals and the Fourth Industrial Revolution. The rapid pace of technological developments played a crucial role in the previous industrial revolutions. However, the fourth industrial revolution (Industry 4.0) and its embedded technology diffusion progress are expected to grow exponentially regarding technical change and socioeconomic impact.

The depletion of Earth's resources at the expense of the Future of Society and the environment has created an epic global challenge. Concepts such as sustainability and social innovation have suffered, which has attracted international attention as potential sustainable resolutions to act as a filter and provide guidance to scrutinize have resurfaced.

Reflect

Coping with such transformation requires a holistic approach under the sustainability umbrella that encompasses innovative and sustainable system solutions, not just technological ones. Art as a form of activism drives social change encouraging Society to propose a framework that can highlight and correct the interaction between man and the environment. The artists in this exhibition employ found materials, story-telling, and advocacy to improve and leverage economic rewards, enrich Society, and protect the environment.

This social perspective demonstrates that interventions like these are likely to affect the diffusion of information and vice versa positively.

Naomi Edobor
November 16, 2022

Exhibiting Artists



Ahmed Abiodun



Anthea Epelle



Gods of Indigo



Musa Ganiyy



Nwajiaku Uche



Nwocha Ernest



Nzekwe Phillip



Olushola Olajobi



Prince Obasi



Samuel Olowomeye



Uchay Joel Chima

Ahmed Abiodun



Ahmed Abiodun Akinrinola is a Nigerian multidisciplinary visual artist and props designer. He graduated from Yaba College of Technology as a sculptor in 2017. He became a recipient of The Oomoba Yemisi Adedoyin Shyllon Art Foundation Residency Award for Best Graduating Art Students after graduating top of his class.
Ahmed explores a plethora of materials and concepts within his environment and mediates between the diversity that stems from foreign influences on contemporary art practices. He was the Art Director for the award-winning Netflix title KASALA and has participated in several exhibitions including, Art For Peace with OYASAF, (Lagos, Nigeria), The Cube at the OYASAF Art Residency, (Lagos Nigeria) and Trading Space at ALARA (Lagos, Nigeria), From Lagos with Love by Art-Bridge, Lagos Nigeria and a resident with DIDA Gallery in Abidjan, Cote Ivoire.

He has participated in several group exhibitions, performance art projects, installations and collaborations with renowned artists both locally and internationally. Ahmed currently works as a studio artist, art director and part- time as a set/props designer for movies and major events within and outside Lagos.



JUST US

Medium: Metal and Fibre glass
Size: 152cm x 92cm
Year: 2022

Price: ₦2,000,000



THE BADGE

Medium: Terracotta, Metal, Aluminium panel and Fibre glass
Size: 152cm x 85cm
Year: 2021-2022

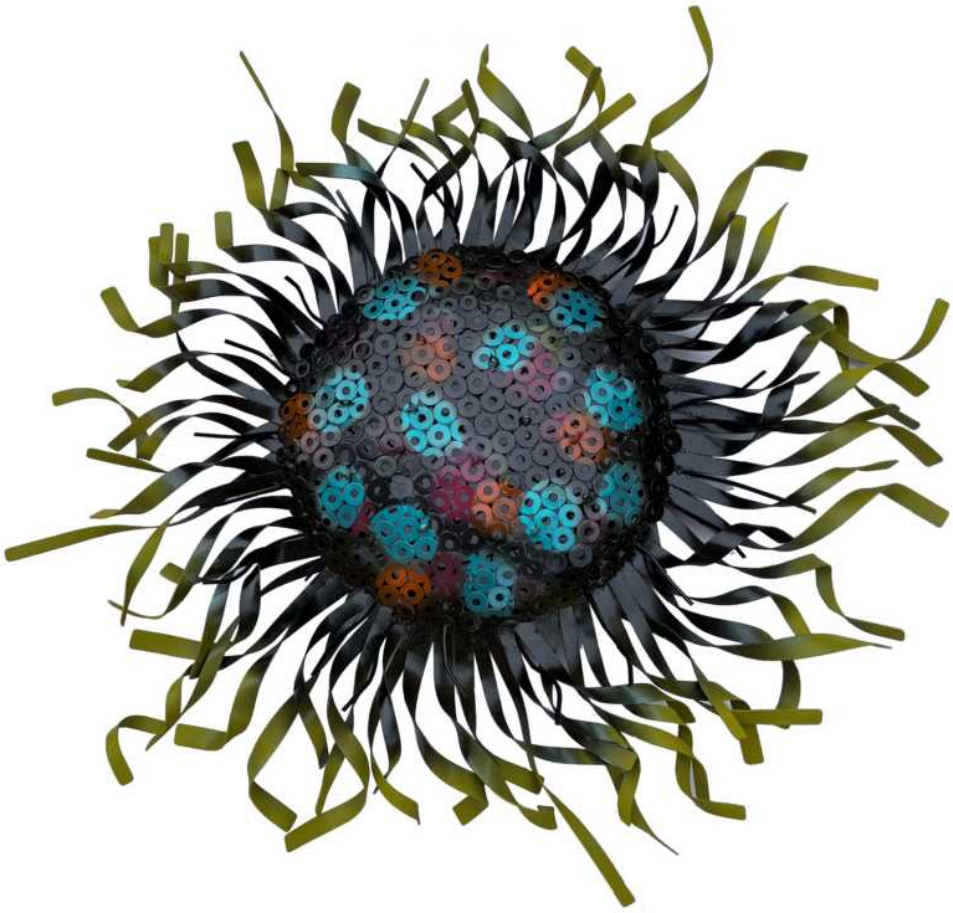
Price: ₦1,700,000



TIDINGS (Gesture from the Maggie)

Medium: Terracotta, Metal and Aluminum pans
Size: 101cm x 63cm
Year: 2022

Price: ₦850,000



CHRYSANTH

Medium: Metal
Size: 152cm
Year: 2022

Price: ₦850,000

Anthea Epelle



Self-taught artist Anthea Epelle (b.1972) creates paintings employing mainly oil on canvas. Born in London, England, Anthea schooled in Lagos and Port Harcourt and later studied Fashion, Design and Technology at The London College of Fashion, UK. She is inspired by expressions, texture, patterns, and alignment; all of which are reflective in her abstract and figurative work.

Since taking up painting professionally in 2007, Anthea has defined her creating process and is still evolving with her practice. She explores portraiture to a great degree and close-ups of these expansive faces call for attention. Anthea s art starts with exploration as she outlines her characters. She enjoys recreating the human face and though she is often drawn to painting women, The Fedora Man 2018 is as glorious. Her use of lines is delicate yet bold they add a vibrancy that is subtly dramatic.

Group exhibitions include Nigeria Our Nigeria at the Presidential Inauguration Exhibition, Abuja (2011), The Contemporaries, at the Wheatbaker Lagos (2015), Women s Month at Rele Gallery, Lagos (2016) and the Afro Modernism in Abuja (2016). Several of her works have been sold at auction by Arthouse Contemporary.

Anthea is featured in the Art of Nigerian Women book by Chukwuemeka, launched in 2016.

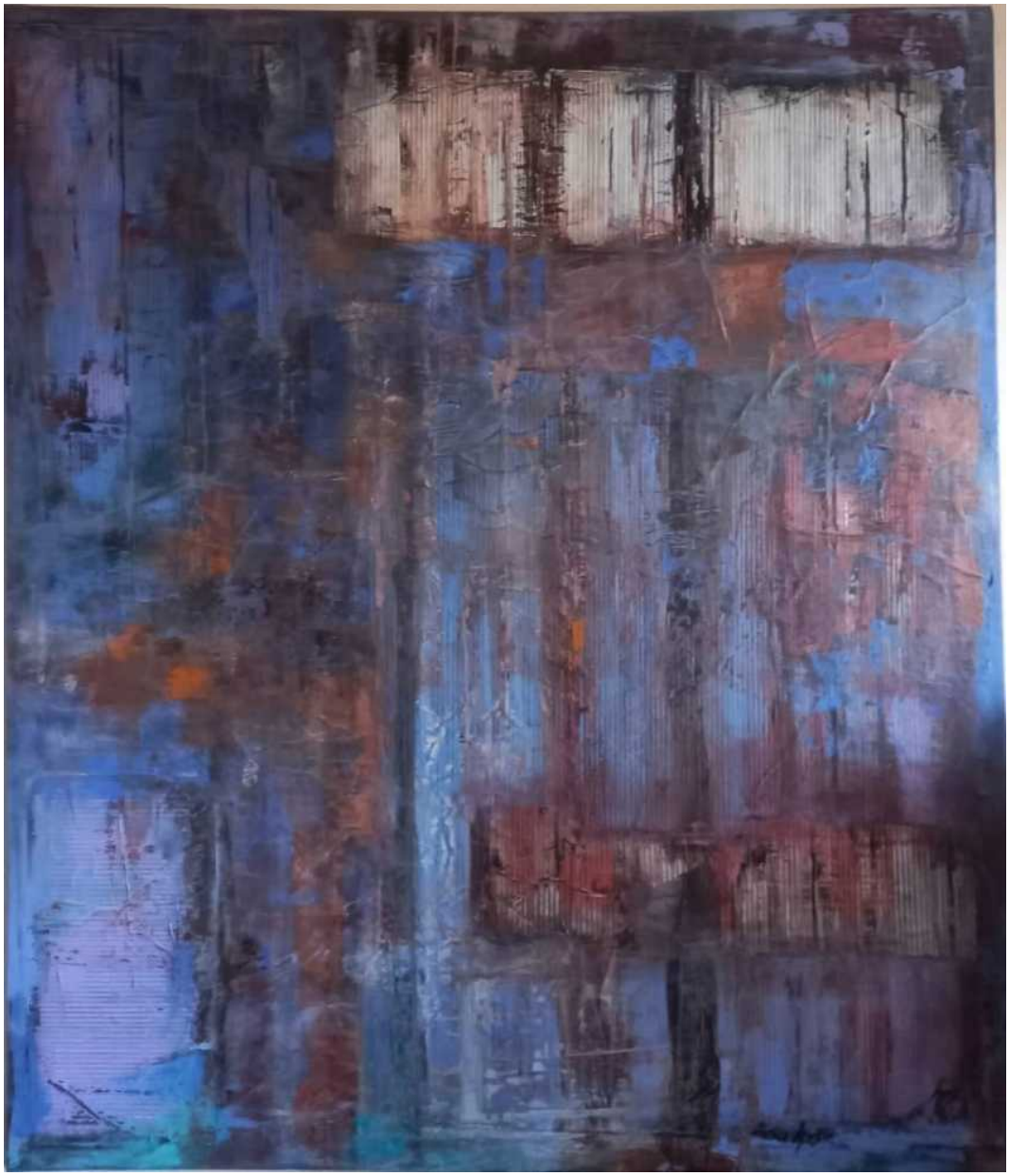
Anthea s forward is going back . She wants art to take her back to her culture, history and roots; in which she plans to translate these on canvas, photography and fashion in a bid to liberate not only the viewer but herself.



TBA

Medium: Oil on recycled cartons on canvas
Size: 40 x 50 In.
Year: 2022

Price :₦900,000



DOWN TO EARTH

Medium: Oil on recycled cartons on canvas
Size: 60 x 70 In.
Year: 2022

Price: ₦2,500,000

Gods of Indigo

We chose the UN's Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) as the main topic and dealt with the protection of the oceans in course series 2.
In collaboration with experts from the respective fields, we set our participants the challenge of creating an exhibition concept within a few course dates, which was then handed over to three artists and developed.
In February 2022, the exhibition "Ocean Belly" was presented around the topic of underwater noise and environmental protection in virtual space.
The video installations can be viewed on the Instagram channel "Gods of Indigo" and, thanks to the cooperation with the XR HUB BAVARIA, in a Mozilla Hub.



"Together with international participants from museums and cultural institutions, we dared to experiment online in the third round of the meaning making program" - Gods of Indigo, 2022

Musa Ganiyy

Musa Ganiyy (b. 1993) is a visual Artist and a photographer based in Lagos, Nigeria.
His works are visual documentation of human interaction with their environment and how people relate to socio-political changes that arrest economic growth in their geographical area.
Ganiyy has chosen to explore different themes ranging from minimalistic compositions to compelling portraits, colorful landscapes and conceptual abstracts, highlighting through these abstract drawings the nostalgic reflections of body movement and noticeable actions of his subjects. African Traditional motifs and patterns are key influences to the visual expressions of the artist.



"My process usually begins as imaginative musing through which I document and illustrate my inter-actions with my environment and by extension, the society I am situated in - Musa Ganiy, 2022



BEFORE WE CALL RANKS

Medium: Acrylic and oil on pastel jute bag
Size: 41 x 43 cm
Year: 2022

Price: ₦500,000



ISSAGOAL ISSAGOAL

Medium: Acrylic and oil on pastel jute bag
Size: 66 x 68cm
Year: 2022

Price :₦600,000

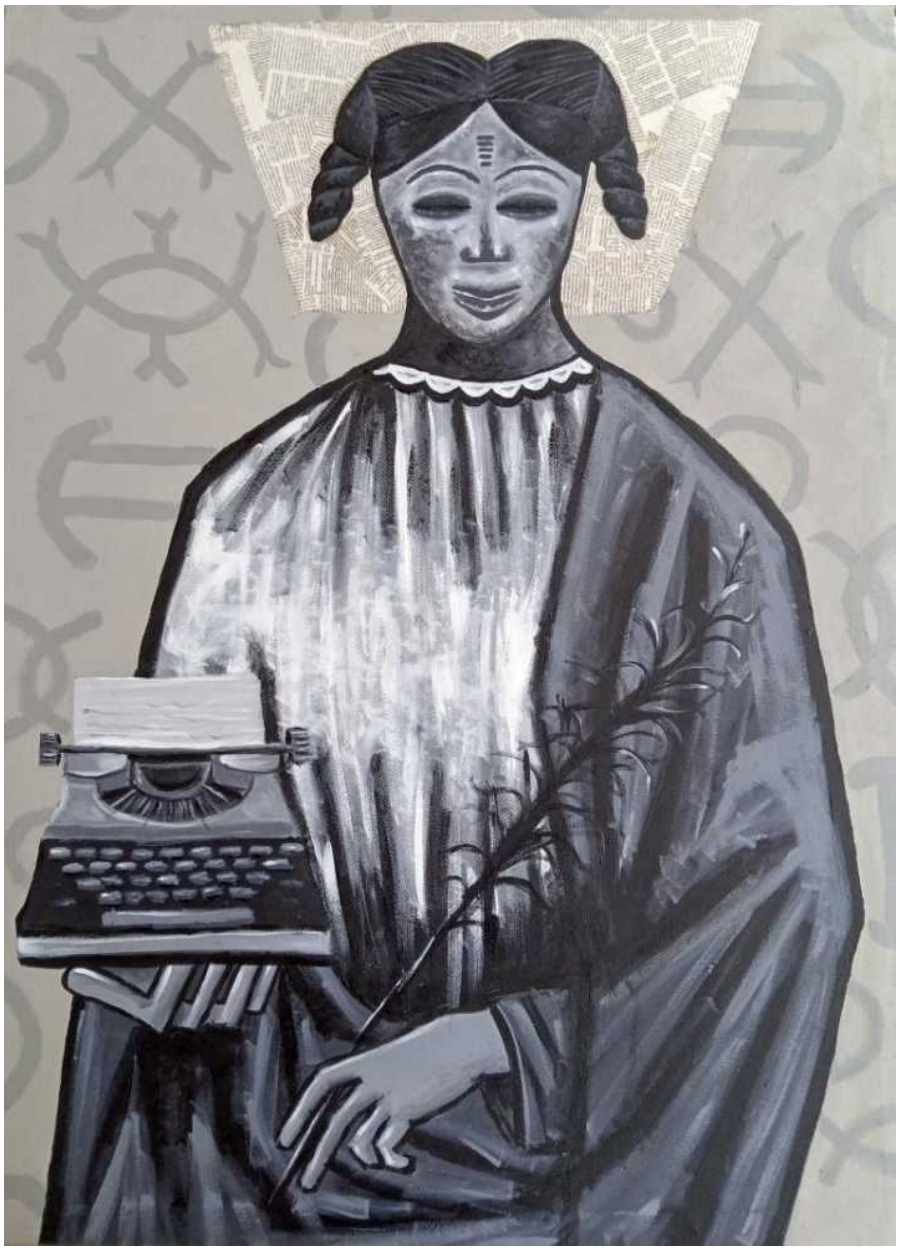
Nwajiaku Uche



Nwajiaku Uche (b. 1997) is an indigene of Umuoji, Idemili North, Anambra State, Nigeria. A prolific visual artist, a researcher and a writer. Nwajiaku grew up in Lagos, Nigeria where he had all his educational exploits. In 2019, he graduated from the University of Lagos where he obtained a B.A. in Visual Arts specializing in Painting. Nwajiaku has featured on several art magazines and art journals which includes Riot and Roux Magazine U.S, March 2021, page 7, The Purposeful Mayonnaise Literary and Art Journal, Issue 1, June/July 2021, (Arts and Words) page 69, Mvibe Magazine (Art) U.S, (Watercolor Section) June 2021, Issue 22.2, and Contranium Digital Magazine.

Nwajiaku emerged as one of the finalists at the nationwide Union Bank Centenary Art Challenge 2017. In 2020 he volunteered as one of the participating visual artists for the Goge Africa beautification project on which he was certified an art ambassador to Goge Africa, a tourist and cultural institution in recognition of his immense contributions to the project. His works explores meeting points between history and modernity with focus on Igbo cosmology and the African society in the post-colonial era, emanating from these meeting points are religion, culture, identity, stereotypes, narratives and personal experiences. He s predominantly a mixed media artist.

"Human evolutionary psychology have continued to evolve through civilization, cosmology, industrialization and existing theories, but social stereotypes and prejudice have remained a constant, hence the need to bring it to the forefront of contemporary society through visual representations - Nwajiaku Uche, 2022



SAINTS OF SOLIPSISM (I)

Medium: Mixed Media
Size: 36 x 48 Inches
Year: 2022

Price :₦1,000,000



SAINTS OF SOLIPSISM (II)

Medium: Mixed Media
Size: 36 x 47 Inches
Year: 2022

Price :₦1,000,000



SAINTS OF SOLIPSISM (III)

Medium: Mixed Media
Size: 36 x 47 Inches
Year: 2022

Price :₦1,000,000



SAINTS OF SOLIPSISM (IV)

Medium: Mixed Media
Size: 36 x 47 Inches
Year: 2022

Price :₦1,000,000



SAINTS OF SOLIPSISM (V)

Medium: Mixed Media
Size: 36 x 48 Inches
Year: 2022

Price :₦1,000,000

Ernest Nwocha



Ernest Nkwocha attended Christ Assembly Primary School and Tin-Can Island High School in Lagos, where he got his early education. He went further to acquire a Higher National Diploma in Sculpting at Auchi Polytechnic, Edo State. He is a member of the Society of Nigerian Artists (SNA), a member of the Sculptors Association of Nigeria (SCAN) and other professional bodies.

Over the years, he has repurposed tyre sculptures which have captured audiences. He has been acknowledged and featured by many TV stations and print publications; including the BBC.

He has participated in various exhibitions both home and abroad. His works were featured and sold in Bonhams Auction, United States. The Moroccan National Museum, Maron Ages Gallery in Lyon, France and Wesleyan University, Ohio, United States, where his life sized Unicorn is displayed.

The actual texture of any tyre is an inspiration to him; he often sees some that are extremely interesting and inspiring, propelling him to work more.

"The actual texture of any tyre is an inspiration - Nwocha Ernest, 2022



WASTE TO WEALTH I (GORILLA)

Medium : Car tyres
Size : 63 x 92 cm
Year : 2020

Price :₦8,000,000



Waste to Wealth II (Ram)

Medium : Car tyres
Size : 45 x 76 cm
Year : 2020

Price :₦6,000,000



Waste to Wealth III (Horse)

Medium : Car tyres
Size : 56 x 162 cm
Year : 2020

Price :₦10,000,000

Nzekwe Phillip



Born in Jos, Nigeria. in 1981, Nzekwe Phillip, is considered to be one of Nigeria's most distinguished experimental artists who explores the rich material culture from his environment, emanating from consumerism. His art comments on daily issues affecting him as an African/ global citizen such as climate change, freedom of expression, the rights of the child, etc.

Through his choice of materials, Nzekwe addresses the effects of mass consumerism resulting in the over exploitation of natural resources in our environment. His artistic creations are made primarily from the junked and jettisoned, which he salvages from his immediate environs. His recent studio research led to his discovery and fabrication of _"Eco-friendly wood"_ -a combination of silica, organic compounds and wood dust; a by-product of the lumber industry and a major environmental pollutant, now harnessed to create an "alternative wood" for sculptors and designers. This is his most recent contribution towards Sustainability and his campaign against mass deforestation; two of the many global issues which he has passionately championed for decades.

"The world is beset with problems, some caused by climate change, fueled by mass consumerism, globalization, corporate greed, disrespect of communal responsibility but my message is not of despair but hope. I use my medium to provoke conversations on sustainability and challenge the complacency to mass consumerism - Nzekwe Phillips, 2022

His artistic techniques are inspired by African traditional arts and achitecture, tropical colors of nature and contemporary 3-dimensional animated images. Phillips Nzekwe has been a fulltime studio artist for close to two decades. He is a recipient of Triangle Trust Grant (2012/ 2013), he has participated and facilitated several artists/ makers workshops including the IICD/US Embassy Workshop, Nigeria, The Triangle Trust Workshops, Kenya, (The Annual) Harmattan Artists Workshops, Niger-Delta, Art and the Community Workshop Series and many others. He was an artist in residence at Kuona Trust Art Center, (Kenya, 2013), Ebedi International Artist /Writers Center, (Nigeria, 2015), Marble Hill School, Delta, state Nigeria and Yemaja Gallery, Lagos, Nigeria (2019).

His solo exhibitions include: 'Crush' Rave Art Fair, Miami (2020), 'Raw Intuition. The National Museum, Lagos (2019), 'Reaching Out', Nairobi Gallery, Nairobi, 'Perspective' 'Quintessence Gallery, Lagos. He has also participated in numerous group exhibitions and fairs as The Rave Art Fair Miami, USA, Impart Art fair Lagos, Nigeria and his works are held in numerous private collections globally.

Having trained under established Nigerian art masters like Bruce Onobrakpeya and Demas Nwoko, he holds a Bachelors and Masters degree in Fine Arts from the Delta State University and Benin University respectively. He lives and works from his Akademik studios of Art located in Lagos and Asaba, Nigeria.



FLORAL DREAM(I)

Medium : Eco-friendly wood
Size : 100 × 70 × 30cm
Year : 2021

Price :₦2,500,000



FLORAL DREAM(II)

Medium : Eco-friendly wood
Size : 80 × 83 × 35cm
Year : 2021

Price :₦2,500,000



SEAT OF POWER

Medium : Eco-friendly wood
Size : 120× 890× 75cm
Year : 2019

Price :₦4,000,000

Olushola Olajobi

In this series, "ASỌ NI MORÓ, EWÉ LORÓ" (I wear clothes, you wear leaf), I question our motive behind buying products or goods which in most cases are as a result of the capitalist ideology that owning a particular product means you are more than, although these end up as wastes.



Olushola O. Olajobi is an independent art history scholar, certified project manager and practicing visual artist who strives for excellence where skills, potentials and visual experience can be fully utilized for the betterment and growth of set objectives. Over the past 2 years, Olushola has been exploring the upcyling of nylon wastes in creating interesting installation pieces through weaving.

Olushola O. Olajobi is a graduate student of Art history at the department of Creative Arts, University of Lagos and he holds an Ordinary National Diploma in Art and Designs from The Polytechnic Ibadan and a Bachelor of Arts in Art history from the University of Benin, Benin city, Edo State.

"Human evolutionary psychology have continued to evolve through civilization, cosmology, industrialization and existing theories, but social stereotypes and prejudice have remained a constant, hence the need to bring it to the forefront of contemporary society through visual representations - Nwajiaku Uche, 2022



ASỌ NI MORÓ, EWÉ LORÓ 1

Medium: Weave Nylon Wastes
Size: 76 x 112 inches
Year: 2021

PRICE:₦650,000



ASỌ NI MORÓ, EWÉ LORÓ 4

Medium : Weave Nylon Wastes And Wool
Size 72 x 49 Inches
Year : 2022

PRICE:₦450,000

Prince Obasi



Prince Obasi (b. 1980's) is a figurative painter based in Port Harcourt, Nigeria. Educated at the prestigious Yaba college of Technology, Yaba, Lagos State, Obasi obtained a Higher National Diploma (HND) in Fine Art with a major in painting in 2009.

Embarking on his artistic journey, Obasi taught visual art in several colleges before transitioning into full-time studio practice in 2019. Based in Port Harcourt, his studio is also known as OBASISM STUDIO. He is also a member of Society of Nigeria Artist, Rivers Chapter (SNA).

He is a prolific painter, with an unfathomable bond with acrylic and charcoal as a medium to illuminate his own artistic language of contemporary figurative art, with a self-discovered alteration of the human eyes. He is famous for the square eyes and pupils of his figures, which in a joyful and quirky way invite the viewer to take a closer look at the canvas. The immaculate details embedded in the dress and painted environments of his characters, make his canvases a unique vessel for representation of human character. Prince has participated in some solos and group shows including; 2021 EUPHORIA (An Artist Reflection in Color), Thought Pyramid Art Center, Abuja, 2021 Golden Square, Signature Gallery, Lagos State, 2022 BAD POSTURE, Eclectica Gallery, Cape Town, South Africa, 2020 Sogal African Contemporary Auction, Signature Gallery, Lagos State, 2020 OREZE VII (The King s Crowd), Onitsha, Anambra State, 2019 New Frames Art Exhibition (SNA), Presidential Hotel, GRA, Port Harcourt, 2019 Private Art Exhibition, Gallery 44, Ikoyi. Lagos State, 2019 Les Contemporains, Alexis Gallery, Victoria, 2019 Contemporary Art Auction, Signature Gallery, Lagos State, 2005 Within our Grasp, Yusuf Grillo Gallery, YABATECH, Lagos State.



CLOWNFISH vs MAN I (Red Clownfish)

Medium: Acrylic and charcoal
Size: 3feet x 2.5feet
Year: 2022

Price: ₦1,500,000



CLOWNFISH vs MAN ll (Blue Clownfish)

Medium: Acrylic and charcoal
Size: 3feet x 2.5feet
Year: 2022

Price: ₦1,500,000

Samuel Olowomeye



As much as humans are referred to as higher animals, the fact still remains that humans are animals. This therefore means that we are a part of the large species that occupy the earth hence, coexistence is inevitable. It is unfortunate that our behavior towards our immediate environment has endangered not only other animals but ourselves..

Born in 1992 in Okitipupa, Ondo State, Nigeria. Samuel Olowomeye holds a degree in Performing Arts from the University of Ilorin. He also has a Masters in Public Administration (MPA) from the same university.
Samuel s works highlight the chaos and imbalance in Nigerian society. He is influenced by his immediate environment and the richness of the Yorùbá culture and is passionate about promoting it.

As a self-trained artist, Samuel sees himself as a critic and observer. The artist works with oils, acrylics, pastel and charcoal to give his paintings strong physical presence. That presence is enhanced by his skill at creating lifelike figures that can be mistaken for photographs. He has a special interest in capturing details.
Samuel currently works from Lagos, Nigeria.

''I Can't Breathe is an attempt to call attention to humans' hypocrisy in dealing with her environment and a mockery of her pretentious empathy'' - Samuel Olowomeye, 2022



I Can’t Breathe 1

Medium : Oil on canvas
Size : 48 x 48 inches
Year : 2022

Price :₦2,800,000



I Can’t Breathe 2

Medium : Oil on canvas
Size : 48 x 48 inches
Year : 2022

Price :₦2,800,000

Uchay Joel Chima



Uchay Joel Chima (born 1971) graduated from the Art School of the Institute of Management and Technology, Enugu, Nigeria. Uchay is known for his eclectic use of alluring materials and unique artistic process, often questioning environmental and social issues around the world. He has created many avant garde works through media such as; performance art videos and two dimensional sculptures made from found objects. His works have continued to evolve, remaining relevant to developments in contemporary art.

A staunch environmentalist, Chima employs a wide range of found materials (including charcoal, old sacks, sand, strings, wax) to create thought provoking, mixed media works that force the viewer to recognize the importance of the discourse around climate change.

Uchay Joel Chima has participated in exhibitions in Nigeria, South Africa, Canada, Sweden, Germany, Netherlands, United Kingdom, and U.S.A. In 2009, he received the award for best video art project from the Center for Contemporary Art, in Lagos. He is one of the four artists chosen through a competitive international selection process to take part in 2015/2016 Platte forum s Artist Residency program in Denver, Colorado. He has been in residence at Vermont Studio Centre, Johnson, Vermont; Spark Box Studio in Ontario, Canada and also at the One Minute Foundation in Amsterdam, Netherlands. His works are featured at international auction houses including Bonhams, Art house Contemporary and Lagos Art Auction. Uchay maintains a studio in Lagos, Nigeria and Houston TX, USA.



SIDON LOOK VI

Medium : Mixed Media
Size : 42 x 42 in.
Year : 2021

Price : ₦1,200,000.00



SIDON LOOK VII

Medium : Mixed Media
Size : 42 x 42 in.
Year : 2021

Price : ₦1,200,000.00



SONG OF A RARE BIRD

Medium : Mixed Media
Size : 28 x 38 in.
Year : 2022

Price : ₦900,000.00



Negotiators I

Medium : Mixed Media
Size : 42 x 42 inches
Year : 2020-2022

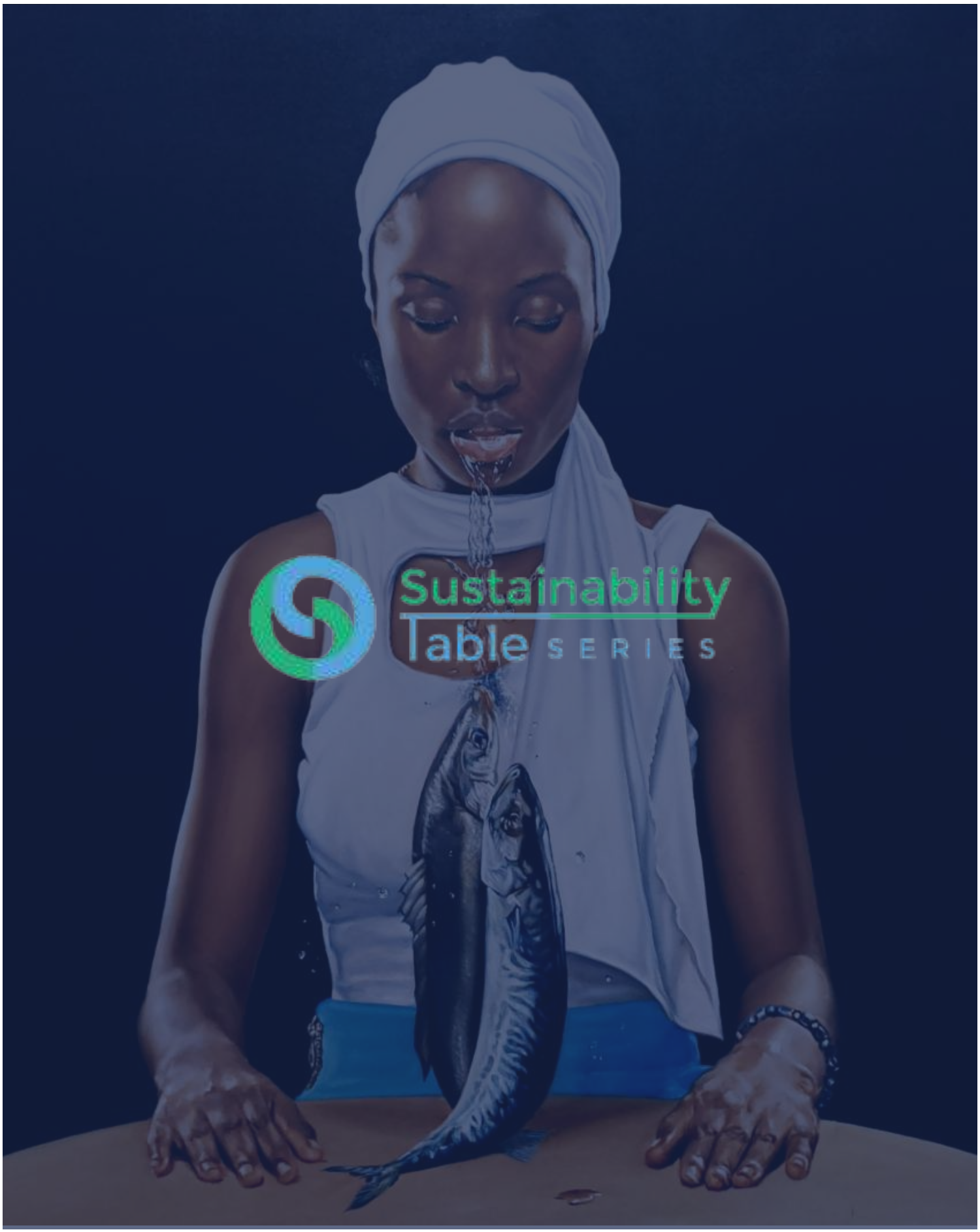
Price :₦1,200,000.00



Negotiators II

Medium : Mixed Media
Size : 42 x 42 inches
Year : 2020-2022

Price :₦1,200,000.00


Sustainability
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